

Länder flags

On German regional flags the arms only appear on the official versions (except Lower Saxony, Saarland, and Rhineland Palatinate).



**BADEN-
WÜRTTEMBERG**

The flag was adopted in 1953. Its colors derive from the arms of Duke Frederick V of Swabia, the coat of arms dates back to 1265. It was adopted as the state arms in 1954.



BERLIN

The flag was first adopted for West Berlin in 1950 and extended to the whole city in 1991. The bear, a pun on the name Berlin, dates from 1338 and the colors from 1861.



BREMEN

The flag of Bremen predates its coat of arms, which was adopted in 1891. Prior to this, Bremen was a member of the Hanseatic League, where the flag originated.



HESSEN

The flag of Hesse was adopted in 1948. The coat of arms was that of Ludwig III of Thuringia in 1182. The red and white colors of the flag are taken from the lion in the arms.



BAVARIA

Bavaria's flag was adopted in 1950, but blue and white have been Bavarian colors since 1330 and the lozenge shapes first appeared on banners in the 15th century.



BRANDENBURG

The colors of the flag are from the shield, dating from 1170, although red and white were also the colors of the medieval Hanseatic League. The flag was adopted in 1990.



HAMBURG

Used since 1325, red and white are the Hanseatic colors. The castle is for Hamburg; the three towers for the Trinity; the cross for Christ; the stars for the Father and Holy Spirit.



LOWER SAXONY

This flag uses the national flag with Lower Saxony's local arms in the center. It was adopted in 1946, but the arms dates from 1361, when it appeared on the seal of the ruler.